

Kill Team Core Rules — How to Play Guide

A clear, player-friendly breakdown of how Kill Team 3rd Edition works.

What You Need

- ▶ Two kill teams (each with their own datacards)
- ▶ 10+ six-sided dice (D6)
- ▶ Tokens/order markers
- ▶ A measuring tape
- ▶ A killzone (game board) with terrain

The Big Picture: How a Game Flows

A Kill Team game is played over Turning Points (typically 4). Each turning point has two phases:

```
Turning Point
├─ 1. Strategy Phase   ← gain CP, use plays
└─ 2. Firefight Phase ← activate operatives, shoot, fight
```

Repeat until all turning points are done. Victory is determined by mission objectives.

STRATEGY PHASE (3 Steps)

Step 1 — Initiative

- ▶ One player has initiative this turning point (they activate first and break ties).
- ▶ Turning point 1: the mission pack decides who has it.
- ▶ Turning points 2+: both players roll off; ties go to the player who did not have it last turn.

Step 2 — Ready

- Initiative player: 1 CP
- Non-initiative player: 2 CP (a small compensation bonus)
- ▶ Each player gains Command Points (CP):
- ▶ All your operatives become ready (flip order tokens to the light side).

Step 3 — Gambit

- ▶ Starting with the initiative player, players alternate using Strategic Gambits (mostly Strategy Plays).
- ▶ Spending CP on a play gives you a rules bonus for the turn.
- ▶ Once both players pass consecutively, the Gambit step ends.
- ▶ Each Strategic Gambit can only be used once per turning point.

FIREFIGHT PHASE

Players alternate activating one ready operative at a time. Initiative player goes first.

When it's your turn to activate, pick a ready operative and do 3 things:

Step 1 — Determine Order

Give the operative either:

Order	Benefits	Restrictions
Engage	Full actions, can Counteract	No special protection
Conceal	Not a valid target while in cover	Cannot Shoot, Charge, or Counteract

Tip: Use Conceal on operatives you want to keep alive while repositioning. Use Engage on operatives ready to fight.

Step 2 — Perform Actions

The operative spends Action Points (AP) up to their Action Point Limit (APL) — usually 2.

- ▶ You cannot perform the same action more than once per activation.
- ▶ If an action is cancelled mid-way, you don't spend the AP.

Step 3 — Expended

After the operative is done, flip their token to the dark side (expended). They're done this turning point.

ACTIONS

Movement Actions

Action	AP Cost	What it Does
Reposition	1	Move up to your Move stat. Cannot enter enemy control range unless a friendly is already there. Cannot combine with Fall Back or Charge.
Dash	1	Move up to 3". Cannot climb. Cannot combine with Charge. Cannot start/end in enemy control range.
Fall Back	2	Move while in enemy control range. Must start in control range; cannot end there. Cannot combine with Reposition or Charge.
Charge	1	Move up to Move + 2". Must end within enemy control range. Requires Engage order. Cannot combine with Reposition, Dash, or Fall Back.

Vertical Movement

- ▶ Climb: Must be within 1" horizontally and 3" vertically of terrain. Each climb counts as minimum 2" of movement.
- ▶ Drop: Ignore the first 2" of vertical distance when dropping (per action).
- ▶ Jump: From Vantage terrain higher than 2" above the floor, you can jump up to 4" horizontally.

Combat Actions

Action	AP Cost	What it Does
Shoot	1	Ranged attack. Requires Engage order and not be in enemy control range.
Fight	1	Melee attack. Must have an enemy in your control range.

Objective Actions

Action	AP Cost	What it Does
Pick Up Marker	1	Grab a controllable marker you're controlling. Cannot be in enemy control range or already carrying a marker.
Place Marker	1	Put down a carried marker within your control range. (If incapacitated, this costs 0 AP and happens automatically before removal.)

COUNTERACT

When all your operatives are expended but your opponent still has ready ones, you don't just sit there — you Counteract.

- ▶ Pick an expended operative with an Engage order.
- ▶ They perform one free 1AP action (excluding Guard).
- ▶ They cannot move more than 2" while counteracting.
- ▶ Each operative can Counteract once per turning point.
- ▶ This is NOT a normal activation — it's a reaction.

SHOOTING (Step-by-Step)

1. Select Weapon

Collect D6s equal to the weapon's Atk (Attack) stat.

2. Select Valid Target

The target must be visible to your operative.

- ▶ If the target has a Conceal order AND is in cover → they are not a valid target.
- ▶ You cannot shoot if friendly operatives are within the target's control range (1").

3. Roll Attack Dice

Roll all your attack dice. A success = roll equal to or higher than the weapon's Hit stat.

- ▶ Roll a 6 = always a critical success (better damage).
- ▶ Roll a 1 = always a failure.

Obscured target (enemy is behind Heavy terrain, >1" away from both operatives):

- ▶ Discard one success from your roll.
- ▶ All critical successes become normal successes.

4. Roll Defence Dice

The defender rolls 3 defence dice. A success = roll equal to or higher than their Save stat.

Cover bonus: If the defender is in cover (and has Engage order), they keep one free normal success automatically — before rolling.

5. Resolve Defence Dice

The defender uses their successes to block attacker successes:

- ▶ Normal success blocks 1 normal success.
- ▶ 2 normal successes can block 1 critical success.
- ▶ Critical success blocks any 1 success (normal or critical).

6. Resolve Damage

Each unblocked attacker success inflicts damage:

- ▶ Normal success → Normal Damage (from weapon stat)
- ▶ Critical success → Critical Damage (from weapon stat, usually higher)

Reduce the target's Wounds by the damage total. If Wounds reach 0 or less → Incapacitated → removed from the killzone.

FIGHTING (Melee — Step-by-Step)

1. Select Enemy Operative

Pick an enemy in your control range (within 1" and visible).

The enemy operative will retaliate this same action.

2. Select Weapons & Roll

- ▶ Both players pick their melee weapon and collect dice (Atk stat).
- ▶ Both players roll simultaneously.
- ▶ Hit successes work the same as shooting (meet or beat the Hit stat; 6 = crit; 1 = fail).

Assisted Fighting: If friendly operatives (not themselves in another enemy's control range) are within the enemy's control range, your melee Hit stat improves by 1 for each assisting operative.

3. Alternate Resolving Dice

Players take turns resolving one die at a time:

- Normal blocks Normal.
- Critical blocks either Normal or Critical.
- ▶ Strike — inflict damage (normal or critical) and discard the die.
- ▶ Block — allocate to cancel an opponent's unresolved success.

Keep going until one operative is incapacitated or all dice are resolved.

KEY CONCEPTS

Control Range

An operative is in control range of another if they are:

- ▶ Within 1" AND
- ▶ Visible to each other

Control range is mutual — it applies to both operatives simultaneously.

Cover

An operative is in cover if there is intervening terrain within their control range.

However, you cannot be in cover if you are within 2" of the attacker.

Obscured vs. In Cover

- These are two different things:
- ▶ In cover = terrain is between you and the attacker, within your control range → defender gets a cover save.
 - ▶ Obscured = Heavy terrain is between attacker and target, more than 1" from either → attacker loses a success and crits become normals.

Wounds & Injury

State	Condition	Penalty
Healthy	At or above starting Wounds	None
Injured	Below half starting Wounds	-2" Move, -1 to Hit (worse)
Incapacitated	0 or fewer Wounds	Removed from killzone

Visibility

An operative is visible if you can draw a straight unobstructed line (1mm wide, imaginary) from your operative's head to any part of the target's miniature (not just the base).

An operative is always visible to itself.

Markers & Objectives

- ▶ Objective markers: 40mm diameter.
- ▶ Other markers: 20mm diameter.
- ▶ An operative contests a marker if within control range of it.
- ▶ An operative controls a marker if the total APL of friendly operatives contesting it exceeds the enemy's total APL on the same marker.
- ▶ A carried marker is automatically controlled by the carrier.

COMMAND POINTS & PLOYS

Command Points (CP) are the currency for activating ploys.

Ploy Type	When Used	Notes
Strategy Ploys	Gambit step (Strategy Phase)	These are Strategic Gambits
Firefight Ploys	Firefight Phase	Used during the action phase
Command Re-roll	Anytime (1 CP)	Re-roll one attack or defence die

- Rules:
- ▶ Each non-Command ploy can only be used once per turning point.
 - ▶ You cannot use the same Strategic Gambit more than once per turning point.

DATACARDS

Every operative has a datacard that lists:

Stat	What It Means
APL	Action Point Limit — how many actions per activation
Move	Distance in inches for Reposition/Charge (minimum 4")
Save	Defence dice target number (lower = better saves)
Wounds	How much damage they can take
Atk	Number of attack dice for a weapon
Hit	Roll needed to score a success (lower = more hits)
Normal Dmg	Damage per normal success
Critical Dmg	Damage per critical success

APL modifiers cannot exceed ± 1 from the base value.

DICE RULES

- ▶ A success = rolling equal to or higher than the target number (e.g., 3+ means 3, 4, 5, or 6).
- ▶ 6 = always a critical success on attack dice.
- ▶ 1 = always a failure on attack dice.
- ▶ Re-rolls: Each die can be re-rolled once. You cannot re-roll a die that was already re-rolled.
- ▶ Multiple simultaneous re-rolls: Players alternate choosing to re-roll a die or pass, starting with the initiative player. Continue until both pass.
- ▶ D3: Roll a D6 and halve the result (round up). So: 1-2=1, 3-4=2, 5-6=3.

PRECEDENCE (When Rules Conflict)

Kill Team uses this priority order:

1. An explicit statement that overrides normal rules
2. Designer commentary / FAQ
3. Non-core rules (faction rules, mission rules) beat core rules
4. "Cannot" beats "can"
5. The active player decides (when activating/acting)
6. The initiative player decides (all other ties)

WEAPON SPECIAL RULES

Weapons can have one or more special rules (keywords) printed on their datacard. Here's what every keyword does:

Re-roll Rules

Keyword	Effect
Balanced	Re-roll one of your attack dice.
Relentless	Re-roll any of your attack dice (as many as you want).
Ceaseless	Re-roll any dice showing one specific result (e.g. all your 2s).

Auto-Success Rules

Keyword	Effect
Accurate x	Retain up to x attack dice as normal successes without rolling them (free hits).
Lethal x+	Any success rolled at x or higher counts as a critical success instead. E.g. Lethal 5+ means 5s and 6s are both crits.

Converting Successes

Keyword	Effect
Rending	If you retained any crits, you may also convert one normal success to a critical.
Severe	If you have no crits, you may change one normal success to a critical.
Punishing	If you retained any crits, you may also retain one failed die as a normal success.

Defence-Reducing Rules

Keyword	Effect
Piercing x	Defender collects x fewer defence dice. E.g. Piercing 1 means they roll only 2 dice instead of 3.
Saturate	Defender cannot retain cover saves. Bypasses cover entirely.
Seek	When picking targets, operatives cannot use terrain for cover.
Brutal	Your opponent can only block with critical successes (normal successes are useless for blocking).

Melee-Specific Rules

Keyword	Effect
Shock	The first time you strike with a crit in the sequence, also discard one of your opponent's unresolved normal successes.

Debuff Rules

Keyword	Effect
Stun	If you retain any crits, subtract 1 from the target's APL until the end of their next activation (they get fewer actions).

Area / Multi-Target Rules

Keyword	Effect
Blast x	After shooting the primary target, also shoot against every other operative visible and within x" of the primary (each rolled separately). Cover/obscured status of secondary targets matches the primary target's.
Torrent x	Pick a primary target normally, then pick any number of other valid targets within x" of it (not in friendly control range) as secondary targets. Shoot against all of them separately.

Restriction Rules

Keyword	Effect
Heavy	Cannot use this weapon in an activation where you moved, and cannot move in an activation where you used this weapon.
Hot	After using, roll 1D6. If the result is less than the weapon's Hit stat, the operative takes damage equal to the result × 2.
Limited x	After using this weapon x times total in the battle, it's gone.
Range x	Can only target operatives within x". E.g. Range 9" limits you to close-range shots.

Special Action Rules

Keyword	Effect
Silent	The operative can perform the Shoot action while having a Conceal order (normally you can't shoot on Conceal).
Devastating x	Each critical success immediately inflicts x bonus damage on top of the weapon's normal critical damage.

EQUIPMENT

Equipment gives your operatives extra tools and options. Selected before the battle as part of your game sequence.

Rules:

- ▶ Universal equipment — any kill team can use it.
- ▶ Faction equipment — specific to your kill team (listed in team rules).
- ▶ You cannot select the same equipment option more than once per game.

Universal Equipment Options

Equipment	What It Does
Ammo Cache (×1)	Place a cache marker. Operatives within control range can use a free OAP Ammo Resupply action to re-roll one attack die until the next turning point.
Razor Wire (×1)	Deploy terrain. Operatives moving within 1" of it treat that distance as 1" longer (slows movement). Counts as Exposed and Obstructing terrain.
Comms Device (×1)	Place a marker. While friendly controlled, extends support rule ranges by 3". Cannot benefit from the opponent's Comms Device.

Equipment	What It Does
Mines (×1)	Place a marker. When any operative enters its control range, it triggers and inflicts D3+3 damage on that operative.
Light Barricades (×2)	Two pieces of Light terrain. Provide cover. Feet are insignificant/exposed.
Heavy Barricade (×1)	One piece of Heavy terrain providing robust cover. Must be placed wholly within 4" of your drop zone.
Ladders (×2)	Insignificant terrain. When climbing within control range of a ladder, treat the vertical distance as only 1" (makes climbing cheap).
Portable Barricade (×1)	A personal Light terrain shield. Improves the carrying operative's Save stat by 1 (max 2+). Can be repositioned with the Move with Barricade action.
Utility Grenades	Select two grenades (2 Smoke, 2 Stun, or 1 of each). Each type is a limited-use 1AP action.
Explosive Grenades	Select two grenades (2 Frag, 2 Krak, or 1 of each). Frag: 4 Atk, 4+ Hit, 2/4 Dmg, Range 6", Blast 2", Saturate. Krak: 4 Atk, 4+ Hit, 4/5 Dmg, Range 6", Piercing 1, Saturate. Each limited use.
Breaching Charge (×1)	One-use. Breach actions cost 1 fewer AP (minimum 1AP).

Utility Grenade Detail

Smoke Grenade (1AP): Place a smoke marker within 6" of your operative (must be visible, or on Vantage terrain). The marker creates a 1" horizontal smoke area. Operatives wholly within the smoke area are Obscured to any operative 2" or more away. Additionally, Piercing 2/Crits 2 are reduced to Piercing 1/Crits 1 at range. The marker is removed after D3 activations or at the end of the turning point. Cannot use while in enemy control range.

Stun Grenade (1AP): Select a visible enemy within 6". That operative and each operative within 1" of it must pass a stun test: roll a D6 — on a 3+, subtract 1 from that operative's APL until the end of its next activation. Cannot use while in enemy control range.

Portable Barricade Detail

The Portable Barricade is Protective (Save +1, max 2+) and Portable (provides cover only when the carrying operative is connected to it and the barricade is intervening between the operative and the attacker).

Move with Barricade (1AP): Move up to your Move stat minus 2". Cannot climb, drop, or jump. Remove the barricade before moving; reposition it after. Cannot place within 2" of other equipment. Cannot use while in enemy control range or in the same activation as Fall Back or Charge.

GUARD ACTION

The Guard action lets an operative adopt a defensive stance, ready to react to enemy movements during their opponents' activations.

Taking the Guard Action (1AP):

- ▶ Requires Engage order.
- ▶ Cannot Guard while within control range of an enemy operative.
- ▶ Place a Guard token on the operative to track its status.

How Guard Works:

After any enemy operative performs an action, you may interrupt that enemy activation and select one friendly operative currently on Guard to perform a free Fight or Shoot action. You do not have to target the

operative you interrupted — you can target any valid target.

Guard Ends When:

- ▶ The guarding operative performs any action or moves.
- ▶ The guarding operative's order changes.
- ▶ An enemy operative ends an action within the guarding operative's control range and you do not interrupt.
- ▶ The next turning point begins.

Additional Restrictions:

- ▶ A guarding operative that interrupts cannot Counteract that turning point.
- ▶ If making a Shoot action through Guard at point-blank range (while an enemy is in control range), the operative's Hit stat is worsened by 1 and it cannot retaliate until the enemy's activation ends.

Tip: Guard is a powerful area-denial tool. An operative on Guard in a doorway forces enemies to think twice before running past. It is also the exception to the "you cannot perform the same action twice" rule — Guard triggers a new free action outside of normal activation.

PRE-BATTLE SEQUENCE (Game Setup)

Before any turning points are played, follow these five steps:

Step 1 — Set Up the Battle

1. Agree on the mission pack and select a mission (or roll for it).
2. Set up the killzone: place terrain with their specified terrain types.
3. Place objective markers on the killzone floor in the specified positions.
4. Roll off — winner has initiative for the setup steps.
5. Initiative player selects their drop zone; opponent takes the other.

Step 2 — Select Operatives

1. Each player secretly selects their operatives according to their kill team's selection rules.
2. Both players reveal simultaneously.
3. Each player secretly selects up to four equipment options (no duplicates per player).
4. Both players reveal equipment simultaneously.
5. Each player gains 2 Command Points (CP).

Step 3 — Set Up Operatives

1. Players alternate placing equipment items (initiative player first), then opponents place theirs.
2. Players alternate setting up one-third of their operatives (rounded up) within their drop zone, starting with the initiative player.
3. Each operative placed this way receives a Conceal order.

Step 4 — Play the Battle

- ▶ Roll off for initiative in Turning Point 1 (ties broken by the player who did not have initiative during setup).
- ▶ Play turning points as normal (see game flow above).

Step 5 — End the Battle

- ▶ After four turning points (or when one kill team is fully incapacitated), the battle ends.
- ▶ The player with the most Victory Points wins. Ties are a draw.

KILL TEAM CONSTRUCTION

Kill teams are assembled according to each faction's selection rules (printed in their team rules). Generally:

- ▶ Each kill team is selected from a fixed roster of operative types.
- ▶ Most kill teams field 8–15 operatives depending on their faction rules.
- ▶ You cannot take duplicate operatives unless the kill team's rules specifically allow it.
- ▶ Each operative has a datacard listing its stats, weapons, and any special rules.

APL Cap: APL modifiers (from injuries, ploys, or equipment) can never take an operative's effective APL more than ± 1 above or below its base value.

TERRAIN TRAITS (Full Reference)

Terrain in Kill Team is described by one or more traits. These traits combine to define what the terrain does:

Trait	Rules Effect
Heavy	Provides cover save. If $>1"$ from both shooter and target, causes Obscured penalty.
Light	Provides cover save only — never causes Obscured.
Wall	Fully blocks Line of Sight AND blocks movement. Also provides cover and causes Obscured.
Exposed	Never provides cover. Never causes Obscured. (Examples: ladders, grates, terrain bases.)
Blocking	Represents gaps beneath/between terrain. LoS cannot pass through the gap. For cover/obscured, the gap counts as intervening terrain like the solid terrain around it.
Accessible	Operatives can move through it, but doing so counts as $1"$ extra movement. Only the centre of the base needs to pass through — base size is irrelevant.
Insignificant	Ignored for climbing and dropping calculations. Operatives move over it without height change.
Vantage	An upper level operatives can be placed upon (above the killzone floor). Operatives on Vantage terrain gain bonuses against lower targets (see below).
Ceiling	Operatives with a round base $\leq 50\text{mm}$ or oval base $60\times 35\text{mm}$ can move underneath Ceiling terrain regardless of operative height.
Protective	Improves the carrying/attached operative's Save stat by 1 (max $2+$).
Obstructing	Operatives moving within $1"$ of this terrain treat that distance as $1"$ longer.

Vantage Terrain — Shooting Bonuses

When an operative on Vantage terrain makes a Shoot action against an enemy with Engage order:

Target is Lower by...	Bonus
$2"$ or more	Accurate 1 (retain 1 attack die as a free normal success without rolling)
$4"$ or more	Accurate 2 (retain 2 attack dice as free normal successes without rolling)

Additionally:

- ▶ Operatives with Conceal order that are 2" or more lower than a Vantage shooter cannot use Light terrain for cover (though they keep any improved Save stat bonuses).
- ▶ For the purposes of Obscured, ignore any Heavy terrain that is connected to the Vantage terrain that both the shooter and target occupy simultaneously.

KILLZONE-SPECIFIC RULES

Gallowdark (Close Quarters — Enclosed Vessel)

Gallowdark is an enclosed starship corridor environment. Its walls are solid Wall terrain — LoS and movement are fully blocked by them.

Close Quarters Special Rule:

Weapons with the Blast, Torrent, and/or Devastating x" weapon rules also have the Lethal 5+ weapon rule while in this killzone. This means 5s and 6s on attack dice both count as critical successes — reflecting how devastating explosives are in enclosed spaces.

Hatchways:

Hatchways have two states — Closed and Open.

State	Access Point	Hatch Piece
Closed	Heavy + Wall (fully blocks LoS/movement)	Heavy + Wall
Open	Accessible + Insignificant + Exposed	Heavy + Wall (gap underneath = Blocking)

Operate Hatch (1AP): Open or close a hatchway whose access point is within your control range.

- ▶ Can be performed during a Dash or Reposition if movement remains.
- ▶ Cannot perform while within enemy control range.
- ▶ Cannot perform if the hatchway is open and its access point is within an enemy's control range.

Hatchway Fight (1AP): Fight across an open hatchway. Select an enemy on the opposite side of the access point within 2" while your base is touching the access point.

- ▶ Both operatives are treated as being within each other's control range for the duration of the action.
- ▶ Cannot perform while within enemy control range.

Tomb World (Ancient Facility)

Hatchways work identically to Gallowdark (see above).

Breach Points:

Breach points are a permanent alternative to hatchways — once opened, they stay open.

State	Access Point	Breach Wall
Closed	Heavy + Wall (fully blocks LoS/movement)	Heavy + Wall
Open (permanent)	Accessible + Insignificant + Exposed	Removed permanently

Breach (2AP or 1AP): Open a closed breach point whose access point is within your control range.

- ▶ Costs 1AP (instead of 2) if the operative has a breach marker, grenadier, or mine keyword on their datacard, or is using a weapon with Piercing 2 or Piercing Crits 2 (but not if the weapon also has Blast or Torrent).
- ▶ Damage: Roll a D6 for each operative on the other side of the access point that has it within their control range. On a 4+, subtract 1 from that operative's APL until the end of its next activation, and inflict damage equal to half the dice result (rounded up).
- ▶ Cannot perform while within enemy control range.
- ▶ Cannot perform if the breach point is already open.
- ▶ Cannot perform in the same activation as a Charge or Shoot action if cost-reduced to 1AP.

Teleport Pads:

The Tomb World contains two Teleport Pads (Exposed, Insignificant, Vantage terrain). Only one operative may occupy a pad at a time. Operatives on a pad cannot touch the killzone floor.

From Turning Point 2 onward: when a friendly operative on a Teleport Pad performs a Charge, Fall Back, or Reposition action, you may teleport it instead — remove it and place it on the other Teleport Pad, still fulfilling all other action requirements (e.g. a Charge must still end in enemy control range). An operative cannot teleport more than once per activation.

If another operative already occupies the destination pad, the two swap positions. If the occupant is an enemy, their controlling player places them.

Compound Siege (Fortified Positions — Volkus)

The Compound Siege upgrade adds fortified structures (stockades and bunkers) with special shooting and movement rules.

Visibility: LoS cannot be drawn over the Heavy terrain of a bunker or stockade unless the drawing operative is at least 2" higher in elevation.

Windows: Work like standard windows — LoS through a window requires you or the target to be within 1" horizontally of the window. Additionally:

- ▶ Weapons with Piercing are ignored by defenders firing through or being shot through a fortified window (the fortification neutralises armour-penetrating rounds).
- ▶ For Blast/Torrent weapons, secondary targets must be on the same side of the fortification as the primary target.
- ▶ Devastating effects only apply to operatives on the same side as the primary target.

Fighting: When fighting across a fortified position (window only, not breach points), the defender resolves their dice first.

Climbing: Treat vertical distance on fortified Heavy terrain as 4" (making climbing very costly).

Open Stockade Door (1AP): Open a closed stockade door if its interior access point is within your control range. Can only be used from inside the stockade. Cannot perform if the door is already open.

Bheta-Decima (Industrial Platform — Hazardous Areas)

This killzone features Gantries (elevated platforms) and Hazardous Areas (toxic/predator-infested zones).

Gantries:

- ▶ Gantry floors are Accessible and Vantage terrain.
- ▶ Gantry pillars are Heavy terrain.
- ▶ Connected gantries (floors touching) are treated as the same terrain feature.
- ▶ The Thermometric Condenser: roof is Accessible + Vantage; roof inner-ledge is Exposed + Insignificant; battlements are Light; all other parts are Heavy.

Hazardous Areas:

- ▶ No part of any operative's base may touch a Hazardous Area. Operatives must navigate around them.
- ▶ Floor-to-floor targeting: An operative on the killzone floor cannot target another floor operative if 4" or more of Hazardous Area lies along the targeting line between them.
- ▶ Vantage-to-floor targeting: An operative on Vantage terrain cannot target a floor operative if the footprint of a gantry lies along the targeting line — except for gantries the shooter or target is actually on.
- ▶ Use targeting lines to determine whether a Hazardous Area or gantry footprint intervenes.

Equipment Placement: Equipment may be set up on Vantage terrain and within 2" of Accessible terrain in this killzone (overriding the usual floor-only restriction).

APPROVED OPS 2025 — COMPETITIVE MISSIONS

Approved Ops 2025 is the standard competitive mission pack. It adds initiative cards, a three-op scoring system, and tac ops.

Initiative Cards

The loser of each turning point's initiative roll-off gains an initiative card (except Turning Point 4):

Turning Point	Card Gained by Loser
1 (setup)	Re-roll Initiative card
2	+2/−2 Initiative card
3	+3/−3 Initiative card
4	No card

Re-roll Initiative card: Play before or after rolling to re-roll your initiative die.

+X/−X cards: After rolling, modify your result up or down by X (can go above 6 or below 1).

Players alternate playing initiative cards or passing (both pass consecutively to end the step). The +X/−X value gives the loser a significant swing in later turns.

The Three Ops

Each battle scores from three parallel objectives simultaneously:

1. Kill Op (max 6 VP)

Track how many enemy operatives you incapacitate using a Kill Grade scale.

Kill Grade	Score
Advance to each new grade	+1 VP
Your grade > opponent's grade at battle end	+1 VP

Kill grade thresholds are based on the starting size of the enemy kill team. Example for a 10-operative team:

Grade	Operatives Incapacitated
1	2
2	4

Grade	Operatives Incapacitated
3	6
4	8
5	10

2. Crit Op (max 6 VP)

One shared Crit Op is selected (or randomly determined) before the battle. During each turning point, operatives perform mission actions on objective markers. Available Crit Ops include:

Crit Op	Mission Action	Scoring
Secure	1AP — one marker you control is secured (remains yours until enemy secures it)	1VP per secured marker; +1VP if you control more than opponent
Loot	1AP — one marker you control is looted	1VP per loot action (max 2VP/turn)
Transmission	1AP — one marker you control is transmitting until next turn start	1VP per transmitting marker; +1VP if more transmitting than opponent
Orb / Stake Claim / Energy Cells / Download / Data / Reboot	Various objective-marker interactions	Varies

Mission action restrictions (all Crit Ops): Cannot perform the mission action during Turning Point 1, or while within control range of an enemy operative.

3. Tac Op (max 6 VP)

Each player secretly selects one Tac Op from their kill team's eligible archetypes. Tac Ops are personal hidden objectives.

Archetypes: Each kill team is assigned one or more archetypes — Infiltration, Recon, Security, or Seek & Destroy. You pick one Tac Op from any archetype your team has access to.

Revelation: Each Tac Op specifies when it should be revealed. Some must be revealed when you complete them; others at battle end.

Scoring: Up to 6VP from your chosen Tac Op.

Primary Op

During Turning Point 1's Gambit step, each player secretly selects one of their three ops (Crit, Kill, or Tac) as their Primary Op (place a face-down card or conceal a die under a cup).

At the end of the battle, both players reveal their Primary Op simultaneously and score additional VP equal to half their earned VP from that op (rounded up).

Maximum 6VP per op — the Primary Op bonus uses the same capped score.

Game Sequence Summary (Approved Ops 2025)

PRE-BATTLE:

1. Select kill teams per faction rules
2. Set up killzone + terrain types
3. Select shared Crit Op; place objective markers
4. Roll-off for initiative → winner picks drop zone
5. Loser gains Re-roll Initiative card
6. Secretly select operatives → reveal simultaneously
7. Secretly select up to 4 equipment → reveal simultaneously
8. Both players gain 2 CP
9. Secretly select Tac Op
10. Alternate placing equipment, then setting up operatives (1/3 at a time, Conceal order)

TURNING POINT 1:**Strategy Phase:**

- Roll initiative (initiative cards can be played)
- Ready operatives, gain CP
- Gambit: secretly select Primary Op (face-down) + other plays

Firefight Phase: normal activations

TURNING POINTS 2-4:**Strategy Phase:**

- Roll-off; loser gains initiative card (TP 2&3 only)
- Alternate playing initiative cards or passing
- Ready + gain CP + Gambit plays

Firefight Phase: normal activations

END OF BATTLE:

- Reveal Primary Op simultaneously
- Score +half VP from Primary Op (rounded up)
- Most VP wins; ties = draw

JOINT OPS — CO-OPERATIVE / SOLO MISSIONS

Joint Ops is the PvE mission pack. One or two players control a kill team against Non-Player Operatives (NPOs).

Kill Team Selection (Joint Ops)

- ▶ Players use one kill team. Solo: select normally. Co-op: split operatives between two players or each take half.
- ▶ NPOs use generic procedural datacards — no faction selection.

NPO Initiative & Gambits

- ▶ NPOs always claim initiative if they win the roll-off.
- ▶ NPOs always pass during the Gambit step.

NPO Behaviours

Each NPO follows one of two behaviour templates:

Brawler (melee-focused):

Priority action sequence: Fight → Charge → Reposition toward closest enemy with cover → Dash toward closest enemy with cover.

Chooses Engage if it can Fight or Charge; otherwise Conceal.

Marksman (ranged-focused):

Priority action sequence: Fall Back to cover with valid targets → Shoot → Reposition to cover with valid targets → Dash to cover with valid targets.

Chooses Engage if it can Shoot; otherwise Conceal.

Threat Principle

When NPOs make decisions (targeting, movement, etc.), always apply the Threat Principle: NPOs choose the option that is worst for the players. This governs:

- ▶ Which enemy operative to target (the most dangerous one in range)
- ▶ Which direction to move (toward the most threatening player operative)
- ▶ Tie-breaking in activation order

NPO Datacard Tiers

Tier	Role
Trooper	Basic operative; low Wounds and average stats
Tough	More resilient than a Trooper; harder to eliminate
Warrior	Elite combat unit; strong attacks
Heavy	Counts as 2 operatives for incapacitation scoring; significantly higher Wounds

Joint Ops Missions

Mission 1 — Breach:

- ▶ NPOs (combined 90 Wounds) are deployed with Conceal order in cover.
- ▶ Players win: All NPOs incapacitated.
- ▶ NPOs win: All player operatives incapacitated.

Mission 2 — Sabotage:

- ▶ NPOs (combined 90 Wounds) with reinforcements triggered when half are incapacitated.
- ▶ Mission Action (1AP): One objective marker you control is sabotaged.
- ▶ Players win: All objective markers sabotaged.
- ▶ NPOs win: All player operatives incapacitated.

Mission 3 — Escape:

- ▶ NPOs (combined 77 Wounds) with reinforcements.
- ▶ Player operatives that move wholly off the NPO killzone edge are removed as escaped.
- ▶ Players win: More than 50% of operatives escape.
- ▶ NPOs win: All player operatives incapacitated before >50% escape.

MULTIPLAYER OPS — 3 AND 4 PLAYER MISSIONS

Multiplayer Ops supports 3-4 players using combined board layouts.

Player Order

All players roll D6 — highest becomes first player (acts as initiative player), second highest goes second, and so on. This order applies throughout the battle for all initiative-related decisions.

Scoring

Elimination Op (replaces Kill Op):

Track how many enemy operatives each player incapacitates per turning point. Heavy operatives count as two for incapacitation scoring. At each turning point end, rank all players:

- ▶ 1st place: 2VP

- ▶ 2nd place: 1VP
- ▶ 3rd/4th place: 0VP

Crit Op: Identical to Approved Ops 2025 Crit Op but with higher maximum VP caps per marker (up to 3VP per marker per turn for 4-player games).

QUICK REFERENCE SUMMARY

EACH TURNING POINT:

1. Strategy Phase
 - a. Initiative – who goes first?
 - b. Ready – gain CP (1 or 2), all operatives become ready
 - c. Gambit – spend CP on ploys
2. Firefight Phase
 - Alternate activating operatives (initiative player first)
 - Each activation: Give Order → Do Actions → Expend
 - When your operatives are all expended → Counteract instead

WHEN SHOOTING:

Roll Atk dice → hit on Hit value (6=crit, 1=miss)
 Defender rolls 3 defence dice + 1 auto if in cover
 Defender blocks with successes
 Remaining hits deal Normal or Critical Damage

WHEN FIGHTING:

Both roll simultaneously → alternate: Strike or Block
 Critical > Normal for blocking priority

ORDERS:

Engage = full actions + counteract, no free cover
 Conceal = in cover = untargetable, no shooting/charging

COVER = intervening terrain in your control range, **NOT** within 2" of attacker

OBSCURED = Heavy terrain between you and target (attacker loses 1 success, no crits)

CONTROL RANGE = within 1" AND visible

INJURED = below half wounds → -2" Move, -1 Hit

Source: Wahapedia Kill Team 3rd Edition Core Rules (Core Book, February 2026)